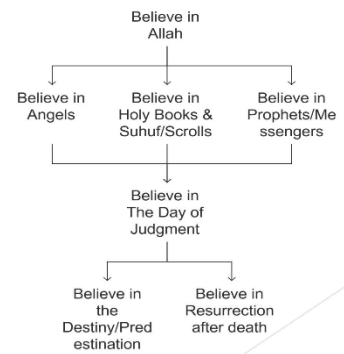


Chap 1 Articles of Faith in Islam

- **Iman-e-Mujmal (Brief Faith):**
 - “I have faith in Allah as He is with all His Names and Attributes, and I accept all His commands.”
- **Iman-e-Mufasssal (Detailed Faith):**
 - “I believe in Allah, His Angels, His Books, His Messengers, the Last Day, and in Destiny, that all good and bad is from Allah, and in the resurrection after death.”

Seven Articles of Faith in Islam



Seven Articles of Faith (Iman-e-Mufasssal)

1. Belief in Allah (Tawheed)
2. Belief in Angels
3. Belief in Divine Books
4. Belief in Prophets and Messengers
5. Belief in the Day of Judgment
6. Belief in Destiny (Qadar)
7. Belief in Resurrection after Death

1 Belief in Allah (Tawhid)

Definition: Believing in one true God, Allah, who is the sole creator, sustainer, and ruler of the universe.

- **Quran:** “There is no god but Allah” (Quran 47:19).
- **Prophet says:** Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) consistently taught that all worship must be directed solely to Allah.

2- Belief in Angels

Definition: Believing that angels are spiritual beings created from light who obey Allah and perform tasks like delivering revelations and recording deeds.

- **Quran:** “And whoever disbelieves in Allah, His angels, His Books, His Messengers, and the Last Day has certainly gone far astray(losing the right path or making big mistakes)” (Quran 4:136).
- **Prophet:** The Prophet (pbuh) received the Quran through the angel Jibril (Gabriel).

3- Belief in Divine Books (holy books sent by Allah (God) to guide people)

Definition: Believing that Allah revealed holy books to guide humanity, including the Quran(Hazrat Muhammad PBUH), Torah (revealed to Prophet Musa AS, Gospel (Injil, revealed to Prophet Isa AS), and Psalms (Zabur, revealed to Prophet Dawud AS).

- **Quran:** “We have sent down to thee the Book in truth, confirming the scripture that came before it” (Quran 3:3).
- **Prophet:** Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) conveyed the Quran as the final and perfect revelation.
- **Sahaba:** The Sahaba memorized and recited the Quran, preserving its guidance for future generations.

4 Belief in Prophets and Messengers: Believing that Allah sent prophets and messengers to guide humanity.

- **Quran:** “We have sent thee inspiration, as we inspired Noah and the prophets after him” (Quran 4:163).
- **Prophet Example:** Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) stressed that all prophets taught the same message of worshiping one God.

5 Belief in the Day of Judgment: Believing that a final day will come when every soul is resurrected and judged by Allah based on its deeds.

- **Quran:** “Every soul shall taste death; then to Us you shall return” (Quran 29:57).
- **Prophet:** The Prophet (pbuh) warned his followers to prepare for this day by living righteously.

6 Belief in Destiny (Qadar): Believing that everything happens by Allah’s will and is part of His divine plan, while humans are still responsible for their choices.

- **Quran:** “And you do not will except that Allah wills” (Quran 76:30).
- **Prophet:** The Prophet (pbuh) encouraged striving for good while trusting in Allah’s decree.

7 Belief in Resurrection (coming back to life after death): Believing that after death, all souls and bodies will be revived for final judgment by Allah.

- **Quran Example:** And the Trumpet will be blown, and all who are in the heavens and all who are ⁵on earth will be terrified” (Quran 39:68).

Introduction to Articles of Faith in Islam

Definition of Iman (Faith):

Iman Means: Acceptance (Tasdiq) of Allah’s truth. Conviction (Yaqin) in His message Commitment (Iltizam) to follow His laws Surrender (Taslim) to Allah’s will.

Which things are involved in our Iman?

1. Heart: Believing in Allah and His message.
2. Tongue: Declaring faith through the Shahada (declaration of faith).
3. Actions: Practicing Islam's teachings and obligations.

Impact of Iman on Ethical Behavior

➤ Guides Our Actions:

Iman shapes how we behave at home, work, and in society.

- **Prophet Example:** Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) always acted with honesty and fairness, even in difficult situations, guiding his community by example.

➤ Builds Moral Character:

- Iman encourages traits like honesty, compassion, and fairness.
- **Sahaba Example:** Abu Bakr (RA) was known for his selflessness and kindness—he shared his wealth to help those in need, reflecting true moral character.

➤ Provides Accountability:

- Iman reminds us that every action is recorded and will be judged by Allah.
- **Prophet Reminder:** The Prophet (pbuh) taught that angels record our deeds, urging us to act justly, much like school rules that hold us accountable.

Believe in Allah – The Oneness of Allah (Tawheed)

Concept Of Tawhid – (Quran & Hadith)

What is Tawheed? (Concept of Oneness of Allah) Tawheed means believing in one, unique God, Allah.

Allah is the sole Creator, Sustainer, and Ruler. This belief is the core of the basis of all worship.

Quran:

- “There is no god but Allah” (Quran 47:19).
- “Say, ‘He is Allah, the One’” (Surah Ikhlas, 112:1).
- “And your god is one God...” (Quran 2:163)

Hadith:

- The Prophet (pbuh) taught, “I testify that there is no god but Allah... forms the basis of the Shahada.

Tawheed According to Surah Ikhlas

Surah Ikhlas (112) Explained:

- Verse 1: “Say, ‘He is Allah, the One’” – Affirms His oneness.
- Verse 2: “Allah, the Self-Sufficient...” – Only He is worthy of worship.
- Verse 3: “He neither begets nor is He begotten” – Rejects any idea of offspring.
- Verse 4: “And none is equal to Him” – No one shares His perfection.

This short Surah sums up the essence of Tawheed.

Categories of Tawhid

There are 3 types of Tawhid:

1. Tawhid al-Rububiyah (Lordship) Allah is the only Creator and Controller.
2. Tawhid al-Uluhiyyah (Worship) - Only Allah deserves our worship.
3. Tawhid al-Asma wa as-Sifat (Names & Attributes) - Allah has unique, perfect names and qualities.

There is nothing like unto Him” (Quran 42:11).

Allah is completely unique and different from everything else.

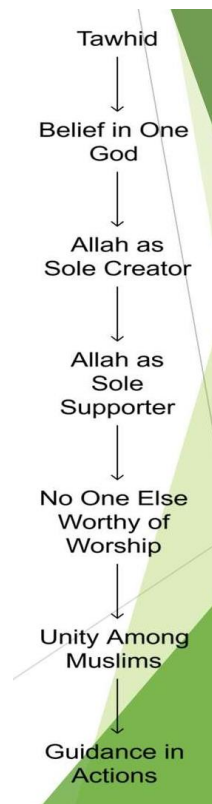
These categories help us understand Allah’s complete uniqueness.

Types of Shirk (Polytheism)

Shirk means directing worship to others besides Allah.

- **Major Shirk (worshiping other gods)** *Quran:* “Indeed, Allah does not forgive association with Him...” (Quran 4:48).
- **Minor Shirk (showing off in worship):** Showing off in acts of worship to gain praise from people instead of pleasing Allah
- **Hidden Shirk (relying on others instead of Allah):** Relying on created things—like wealth, status, or personal ability—instead of trusting solely in Allah.

Shirk is a severe sin in Islam. Avoiding all forms of shirk is essential for maintaining pure faith and a sincere relationship with Allah.



The Moral Impact of Tawheed

Tawheed teaches us to be kind, honest, fair, and caring. It reminds us that Allah knows everything we do and think. This belief encourages us to always do good, treat people nicely, and stay strong in our faith. By following Tawheed, we try to follow the great example of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and his companions, who showed kindness, honesty, and goodness in all parts of their lives.

Importance of Tawheed

Foundation of Islam:

- It is the core of our faith and identity as Muslims.

Key to Salvation:

- Belief in one God is essential for salvation.

Protection Against Shirk:

- Prevents associating partners with Allah.

Unity:

- Unites Muslims worldwide in a common belief.

The Prophet (pbuh) always stressed that worship must be directed only to Allah.

Belief in Angels

What Are Angels?

- Angels are special, invisible beings created by Allah from light. They do not have free will like humans they only follow Allah's commands without question.
- Their purpose is to serve Allah by performing various tasks like delivering messages, protecting people, recording deeds, and worshiping Allah continuously.
- Angels are pure, obedient, and always do what Allah asks them to do.

Quran Verse:

- **“And whoever disbelieves in Allah, His Angels, His Books, His Messengers, and the Last Day has certainly gone far astray.” (Quran 4:136)**

This verse shows that belief in angels is a core part of the Islamic faith. It reminds us that angels play an essential role in Allah's plan.

Hadith:

- **The Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said, “Angels are created from light.” (Sahih Muslim)**

This hadith highlights the unique, pure nature of angels. It teaches us that angels are special beings whose sole purpose is to obey Allah, deliver His messages, and record our deeds.

Categories of angels in Islam – Archangels (Malaika il-Ikram)

- **Jibril (Gabriel):** Delivers Allah's messages to the prophets. Brought the Quran to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH).
- **Mikail (Michael):** Provides sustenance and controls natural forces (rain, wind).
- **Izrail (Azrael):** Angel of death; takes souls at the time of death,
- **Israfil(Raphael):** Will blow the trumpet on the Day of Judgment.

- **Recording Angels:** Write down each person's good and bad deeds. (Quran 82:10-12)
- **Guardian Angels:** Protect and watch over individuals. They help maintain safety and order.
- **Munkar and Nakeer:** Question the dead in the grave about their faith.
- **Punishment Angels:** Execute Allah's punishment when needed. (Quran 96:18)
- **Angels of Mercy/Resurrection/Paradise:** Bring blessings, assist on Judgment Day, welcome believers to Paradise.
Example: Hadrat Ridwan (guard of Paradise).

Characteristics of Angels

- Created from Light: (Quran 81:1)
- Invisible to Humans: (Quran 6:50)
- Always Obey Allah: (Quran 66:6)
- No Free Will: (Quran 16:50)
- No Gender or Human Desires: (Quran 53:27)

Roles of Angels

- **Convey Revelations:** Example: Jibril delivers Allah's messages to prophets.
- **Protect Believers:** Guard and assist us during difficult times.
- **Record Deeds:** Remind us that every action is noted (Quran 82:10-12).
- **Execute Punishment:** Carry out Allah's commands when needed.
- **Assist on Judgment Day:** Help with the final reckoning (Quran 25:25).

Number of Angels and Continuous Creation

- **Daily Creation:** Hadith (Sunan-e-Tirmidhi) mentions 70,000 to 80,000 angels are created daily.
- **Vast Numbers:** 600 wings around Allah's Throne (Bukhari); millions guarding Hellfire (Sahih Muslim).
- **Continuous Creation:** Allah's creative power is endless, showing His boundless majesty.

Bayt al-Ma'mur and Angelic Tawaf

- **Bayt al-Ma'mur:** Known as the "Heavenly Kaaba," located above the Kaaba in the seventh heaven.
- **Angelic Tawaf:** A Hadith in Sahih Bukhari states that 70,000 angels enter Bayt al-Ma'mur daily to perform tawaf (circumambulation).
- **Impact:** Demonstrates the continuous and organized worship in the heavens. An endless, divine ritual of worship that never stops.

Believe in Divine Books

What is Divine Revelation

- Divine guidance is given by Allah through revelations.
- These messages come in the form of holy books and smaller scriptures called Suhuf.
- They serve as the foundation for our morals, social behavior, and ethics.

Example: The Quran teaches us to be honest, fair, and kind, guiding millions to live good, righteous lives.

Requirements for Believing in Divine Books

- **Acceptance:**
 - Believe that all holy scriptures are true and come from Allah.
 - *Quran Example:* "Believe in what has been revealed to you..." (Quran 2:136).
- **Respect:**
 - Treat the words of Allah with great honor and care.
 - *Hadith Example:* The Prophet (PBUH) taught us to hold the Quran in the highest regard.
- **Implementation:**
 - Follow and practice the guidance and teachings found in these books.
 - *Sahaba Example:* The companions learned and lived by the Quran every day.

Impact of Belief in Holy Books (Quran & Hadith)

- **Guidance for Life:**
 - Holy books give clear rules for justice and kindness.
 - *Quran Example:* "And establish prayer and give zakah..." (Quran 2:43) teaches us to support our community.
 - *Hadith Example:* The Prophet (PBUH) said, "Actions are judged by intentions," which guides us to act sincerely.
- **Unity Among Muslims:**
 - A shared belief in divine revelations brings Muslims together.
 - *Quran Example:* "Hold firmly to the rope of Allah..." (Quran 3:103) reminds us to stay united.
 - *Sahaba Example:* The companions, like Hazrat Umar (RA), worked together and supported one another.
- **Moral Foundation:**
 - Holy books encourage us to be honest, just, and kind.
 - *Quran Example:* "Indeed, Allah commands justice..." (Quran 16:90) teaches us to be fair and compassionate.
 - *Hadith Example:* The Prophet (PBUH) said, "The best of you are those who are best

to their neighbors," inspiring ethical behavior.

The Four Major Holy Books

- **The Quran:** Final and unaltered word of Allah revealed to Hazrat Muhammad (PBUH).
- **Torah (Tawrat):** Given to Prophet Moses.
- **Gospel (Injil):** Given to Prophet Jesus.
- **Psalms (Zabur):** Given to Prophet David.

Belief in Prophets and Messengers

Nabi (Prophet) and Rasool (Messenger)

- **Nabi (Prophet):**
 - Receives revelations via an angel (usually Jibril).
 - Guides his community using Allah's message.
- **Rasool (Messenger):**
 - Brings a new (Shariah) scripture and law.
 - Establishes a new religious community based on Allah's message.
- **Key Differences:**
 - Nabi follows existing law; Rasool establishes new law.
 - Rasool's message is broader and community-changing.
- **Key Point:** Every Rasool is a Nabi, but not every Nabi is a Rasool.

The Ulul Azm Prophets

Who Are They? These prophets are very determined and patient. They faced big challenges with strong, unshakable faith.

The Five Ulul Azm Prophets:

1. **Prophet Noah (AS):**
 - preached to his people for a very long time, telling them to worship only Allah His people mostly refused built a huge ark because Allah commanded him to save the believers. Even though people laughed at him, he trusted Allah completely. When the great flood came, his ark saved him and those who believed.
2. **Prophet Ibrahim (AS):**
 - Hazrat Ibrahim (AS) also preached against idol worship. He faced many challenges, including being thrown into a fire, but Allah saved him. He is known for his strong faith and willingness to obey Allah commands, even when they seemed very difficult, such as the command to sacrifice his son. Abraham is considered the father of many prophets.
3. **Prophet Musa (AS):**
 - Led his people out of Egypt, overcoming oppression.
 - Despite facing a powerful Pharaoh, he guided the Israelites to freedom by following Allah's command.
4. **Prophet Isa (AS):**
 - Performed miracles and spread a message of compassion.
 - He healed the sick and showed kindness, reminding people to care for one another.
5. **Prophet Muhammad (SAW):**
 - Muhammad (SAW) is the final prophet in Islam. He received the Quran from God. He faced many hardships while spreading the message of Islam.
 - Hazrat Muhammad (SAW) is known for his exemplary character, and for the completion of Allah message to mankind.
 - Their strength shows us the value of persistence and patience.
 - They inspire us to stand tall in our belief and act with courage and integrity.
 - Their lives serve as simple examples of how to overcome challenges ethically and with faith.

Attributes & Qualities of Prophets

Core Qualities:

- **Truthfulness (Sidq):** Always honest and trustworthy.
- **Trustworthiness (Amanah):** Safeguard divine messages.
- **Wisdom (Fatanah):** Shows deep understanding and insight.
- **Infallibility (Ismah):** Free from major sins; ideal role models.
- **Patience (Sabr):** Steadfast under trials.
- **Justice ('Adl):** Fair and equitable in all dealings.
- **Humility (Tawadu')**: Modest despite high status.
- **Courage (Shaja'ah):** Bold in confronting injustice and facing challenges.

Inspiration from the Prophets Character

- **Role Models for Good Behavior:**
 - Prophets show us how to act with kindness and fairness. Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) treated everyone with respect, even those who disagreed with him.
- **Promote Honesty and Trust:**

- Their words and actions teach us to always be truthful and keep our promises.
- **Encourage Justice:**
 - They stand up for what is right and ensure everyone is treated fairly.
- **Inspire Compassion and Patience:**
 - Prophets show us how to care for others and remain calm in hard times.
- **Guide to a Balanced Life:**
 - Their example helps us balance work, worship, and family responsibilities.
 - *Example:* managing, prayer, and family time so that no part of life is neglected.

Outstanding Characteristics of the Prophet (PBUH)

- **Seal of Prophethood** (*Khatam-un-Nabiyyin*) : Final prophet; his message is complete.
- **Mercy to All Worlds** (*Rahmat-ul-lil-Alameen*) : Sent as a mercy for all creation.
- **Exemplary Character** (*Uswah Hasanah*): Perfect social, spiritual, and moral conduct.
- **Balanced Leadership:** Combines justice with compassion.
- **Direct Communication with Allah:** Experienced Isra and Mi'raj (Night Journey).
- **Universality:** Message for all mankind and jinn.

Finality of Prophethood (Khatm an-Nubuwwah)

- **Belief:** Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) is the last prophet.
- **Quranic evidence:** "...he is the Messenger of Allah and the Seal of the Prophets." (33:40)
- **Hadith Evidence:** "There will be no prophet after me." (Sahih Muslim)
- **Consensus (Ijma')**: Muslim community agrees on the finality of his prophethood.
- **Ethical Implication:** Provides complete and unchanging guidance for life.

Belief in the Day of Judgment

- **Judgment Day:** When Everyone is Held Accountable
- **Day of Judgment:** The Day of Judgment (Qiyamah or Yawm al-Din) is a fundamental concept in Islam

Concept of the Day of Judgment:

- **Resurrection:** Bodies and souls are revived. Allah will resurrect all humans and jinn, restoring their physical bodies.
- **Gathering:** All creatures meet before Allah.
- **Accountability:** Individuals will be judged based on deeds, intentions, and faith.. **Reward & Punishment:** The righteous will enter Paradise (Jannah), while the wicked will be consigned to Hell (Jahannam).
- **Quranic Reminder:** "Every soul shall taste death..." (29:57)

The Trumpet (Sur)

- ❖ The Day of Judgment will be initiated by the blowing of the trumpet (Sur) by the angel Israfil.
- ❖ Two blowing's are mentioned according to the Quran and Hadith.

➤ **First Blowing**

- Nafkhatu'l-Faza' or Nafkhatu'l-Sa'aq (The Blowing of Destruction)
- Initiates the destruction of the heavens and the earth and the death of all living creatures.
- Quranic Reference: Surah Az-Zumar, 39:68

➤ **Second Blowing**

- Nafkhatu'l-Ba'th or Nafkhatu'l- Qiyama (The Blowing of Resurrection)
- Signals the resurrection of all creatures from their graves.
- Quranic Reference: Surah Az-Zumar, 39:68
- Hadith Confirmation: Sahih al- Bukhari & Sahih Muslim

Stages of the Day of Judgment

1. **Al-Qiyamah (Resurrection).** Everyone comes back to life.
2. **Al-Hashr (Gathering).** All people are brought together.
3. **Al-Hisab (Accountability).** Everyone is judged for their actions.
4. **Al-Mizan (Weighing of Deeds).** Good and bad deeds are measured.
5. **Al-Pul Sirat (Crossing the Bridge).** Cross a bridge to our final place.
6. **Al-Jannah (Paradise) or Al-Jahannam (Hell).** Our final home is decided by our deeds.

Signs of the Day of Judgment

1. **Appearance of the Mahdi:** A good leader who will bring justice and help people
2. **Return of Jesus (Hazrat Isa):** Jesus(Hazrat Isa) will come back to help defeat evil and bring peace.
3. **Arrival of the Dajjal (Anti-Christ):** A false messiah who will spread lies and cause problems.
4. **Rise of the sun from the west:** A surprising sign where the sun will rise from the opposite direction.
5. **Collapse of the Kaaba:** The holy building in Mecca may fall apart as a sign of the end times.
6. **More Hardships:** Life will become very difficult, and people will face many challenges.

Believe in the Destiny/ Predestination (Taqdeer/Qadar)

What is Destiny (Qadr)? Destiny (Qadr) means Allah's plan for everything.

- **Concept:** Everything happens by Allah's will and is part of His divine plan. It is a basic belief and one of the six pillars of faith in Islam. Trust in Allah's wisdom and justice is at the heart of this belief.

Four Key Aspects of Destiny

- **Knowledge (Ilm):** Allah knows everything that happened in the past, is happening now, and will happen in the future.
 - *"Indeed, Allah is All-Knowing of all things."* (Surah Al-Anfal, 8:75)
- **Preserved Tablet (Al-Lawh al-Mahfuz):** Every event is recorded by Allah in a special, unchangeable record.
 - *"Do you not know that Allah knows what is in the heaven and earth? Indeed, this is in a Record..."* (Surah Al-Hadid, 57:22)
- **Allah's Will (Mashiah):** Nothing occurs unless Allah wills it. Every event happens only because Allah allows it.
 - *"And you do not will except that Allah wills."* (Surah Al-Insan, 76:30)
- **Creation (Khalq):**
 - Allah is the Creator of everything, including our actions.
 - *"Allah is the Creator of all things..."* (Surah Az-Zumar, 39:62)

Types of Destiny

- **Unrevocable Destiny (Mubram): Definition:** Allah's plan that never changes.
Key Points: Only Allah knows these details. It cannot be changed. Examples: Time of death, place of birth, who your parents are.
- **Revocable Destiny (Muallaq): Definition:** A plan that can change with our actions
Key Points: It depends on our choices. Our actions can change it. Example: (marriage, wealth, health).

Fixed vs. Changeable Destiny

Immutability:

- **Mubram:** Fixed and cannot be changed.
- **Muallaq:** Can be changed by our actions.

Human Influence:

- **Muallaq:** Affected by our choices, prayers, charity, and good deeds.

Knowledge:

- **Muallaq:** Partly known to humans and Allah
- **Mubram:** Known only to Allah.

For example, if you study hard, you expect to get good grades, but unexpected events may also affect your results—this shows that while you can see some outcomes, only Allah fully knows the final result.

Quranic and Hadith References on Destiny

- **Quran Verses:**
 - *"And with Him are the keys of the unseen; none knows them except Him..."* (Surah Al-An'am, 6:59)
 - *"No disaster strikes upon the earth... except that it is in a register before We bring it into being..."* (Surah Al-Hadid, 57:22)
 - *"And We test you with evil and with good as trial..."* (Surah Al-Anbiya, 21:35)
- **Hadith Highlights:**
 - *"Faith is to believe in Allah, His angels, His books, His messengers, the Last Day, and to believe in Qadr, both its good and its evil."* (Sahih Muslim)
 - *"Allah wrote down the decrees of creation fifty thousand years before He created the heavens and the earth."* (Sahih Muslim)
 - *"Strive, for everyone will be facilitated to what he is created for."* (Sahih al-Bukhari & Sahih Muslim)
 - *"Nothing increases one's lifespan except good deeds, and nothing repels divine decree except supplication."* (Jami' at-Tirmidhi)

Believe in Resurrection after death (Rising from the dead)

- **Definition:** Resurrection (Ba'th) is the revival of souls and bodies after death.
- **Purpose:** For judgment and accountability on the Day of Judgment.
- **Key Idea:** Death is not the end; life continues with a final judgment

Quran & Hadith References

Quran:

- "And the Trumpet will be blown, and all who are in the heavens and all who are on earth will be terrified." (Quran 17:71)
- "And We have recorded everything in a clear register." (Quran 36:12)
- "And We have created everything with Qadr (measure)." (Quran 54:49)

Hadith:

- "You will be resurrected with your bodies and wealth." (Sahih Bukhari)
- "The resurrection will be on the Day of Judgment." (Sahih Muslim)

Types of Resurrection

- **Minor Resurrection (Al-Ba'th al-Saghir):** Resurrection of the soul after death, returning it to Barzakh (the intermediate state).
- **Major Resurrection (Al-Ba'th al-Kabir):** The physical revival of bodies on the Day of Judgment.

Categories of Resurrection

- **Al-Hashr (Gathering):** All creatures are gathered before Allah.
- **Al-Mahshar (Gathering Place):** The place where everyone is assembled.
- **Al-Hisab (Accountability):** The process where each person's deeds are judged.

Stages of Resurrection

- **Death (Mawt):** The soul leaves the body.
- **Intermediate Realm (Barzakh):** The soul stays in a temporary place.
- **Resurrection (Ba'th):** Souls and bodies are brought back to life.
- **Gathering (Hashr):** All are assembled before Allah.Judgment
- **(Hisab):** Every deed is weighed and judged.

Resurrection in Surah Al-Baqarah (Verses 259 & 260)

Verse 259:

- A man passed a ruined town and wondered, "How will Allah bring this to life after its death?"
- Allah caused him to die for 100 years and then brought him back, showing that even decayed bones can be reassembled.
- This verse shows that Allah can make dead things come to life, as He did by bringing a man back after 100 years in a ruined town.

Verse 260:

- Prophet Ibrahim asked Allah to show how He gives life to the dead.
- Allah demonstrated this by reviving four birds, proving His power and wisdom.
- In this verse, Prophet Ibrahim asked Allah to show how He can make the dead live again, and Allah proved it by reviving four birds.

Tafsir Commentary (Ibn Kathir's Insights):

According to Ibn Kathir, these verses show that Allah has the power to bring the dead back to life.

The story of Ibrahim highlights that asking questions to strengthen one's heart and faith is important.

Chap 2 Five Pillars of Islam

- **What is Islam?**
 - The word "Islam" means "submission" or "surrender" to Allah.
 - It is a way of life based on obeying Allah's commands.
- **Purpose of Islam:** To worship Allah only. To live a good and fair life. To grow spiritually and prepare for the life after death.

The Five Pillars of Islam

1. **Shahada:** Declaration of Faith
2. **Salah (Prayers):** Performing the five daily prayers.
3. **Zakat (Charity):** Giving a portion of your wealth to those in need.

4. **Sawm(Fasting):** Fasting during the month of Ramadan.
 5. **Hajj (Pilgrimage):** Making a pilgrimage to Mecca if you are able.
- These acts build a strong, balanced life and connect a Muslim to their faith.

Core Principles of Islam:

1. **Tawhid (Oneness of Allah):** Belief in the oneness of Allah.
2. **Risalah (Prophethood):** Belief in the Prophethood (especially Prophet Muhammad).
3. **Akhirah (Afterlife):** Belief in life after death.
4. **Adl (Justice):** Belief in justice.
5. **Ihsan (Goodness):** Belief in doing good and being kind.

1st Pillar–Kalima-e-Tayyib (Declaration of Islam)

- **What is Kalima-e-Tayyib?** The Kalima-e-Tayyib is the pure and clear declaration of a Muslim’s faith. The Kalima: **"There is no god but Allah, and Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah."**
- **Requirements of the Kalima-e-Tayyib:**
 - ❖ **Belief in One God (Tawhid):** Truly believe that only Allah is worthy of worship.
 - ❖ **Belief in Prophet Muhammad:** Accept Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) as Allah’s final messenger.
 - ❖ **Sincere Acceptance:** The belief must come from deep within the heart. Believe with your heart, speak with your tongue, and act according to your words.

Understanding Iman-e-Mujmal: The Heart of Islamic Faith

- **Iman-e-Mujmal (Brief Faith):** “I have faith in Allah as He is with all His Names and Attributes, and I accept all His commands.”

Belief: Iman-e-Mujmal means believing in Allah completely with all His names and qualities.

Spiritual Purification: The Kalima cleanses your soul by reminding you of Allah’s power and the teachings of Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ)

Unity of Purpose: The Kalima brings Muslims together, creating a shared belief and purpose around Allah’s message.

Accountability: It reminds us of the Day of Judgment and inspires us to act righteously.

Two Testimonies of Faith

The Two Important Declarations:

1. Testimony of Monotheism (Shahada of Tawhid):

- “There is no god but Allah.”
- This shows our belief in one God.

2. Testimony of Prophethood (Shahada of Risalah):

- “Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.”
- This shows our belief in the guidance brought by Prophet Muhammad.

One God, One Messenger: Islam is about believing in only one God (Allah) and that Muhammad (peace be upon him) was his prophet. **Promise to God:** Saying the testimonies means you promise to only worship God and follow Muhammad's teachings.

2nd Pillar -Prayer / Salah / Namaz

What Is Prayer? : Prayer, also known as Salah or Namaz, is a special way for Muslims to talk to Allah. It is the second most important act of worship in Islam.

Direct Talk with Allah: Prayer is like having a direct conversation with Allah. It is a time when you speak to Him, ask for help, and say thank you.

- Prayer connects us with Allah and cleanses our sins.
- It is a key part of a successful and balanced life.
- **Quranic Verses:** “Establish prayer, for prayer prevents indecency and evil.” (Surah Al-Ankabut, 29:45)
- “Indeed, prayer has been decreed upon the believers at specified times.” (Surah An-Nisa, 4:103)
- “Successful indeed are the believers, those who humble themselves in their prayer.” (Surah Al-Mu’minun, 23:1-2)

Qualities and Importance of Prayer

- **Cleansing of Sins:** Regular prayers help erase minor sins (Hadith: Five daily prayers and Jumu’ah expiate sins if major sins are avoided)
- **Spiritual Elevation:** Brings inner peace and strengthens faith
“Verily, in the remembrance of Allah do hearts find rest.” (Surah Ar-Ra’d, 13:28)

- **Path to Paradise:** Prayer is the first deed questioned on the Day of Judgment. A sound prayer means other deeds will be sound (Hadith from Tirmidhi)

Consequences of Skipping Prayer

Worldly Consequences:

- **Loss of Blessings:** Skipping prayer can lead to missed opportunities for blessings in life. Without the regular act of prayer, you might face unexpected hardships and challenges. (Surah Taha, 20:124)
- **Spiritual Deprivation:** When you do not pray, your heart may feel empty and lose its connection with Allah. This spiritual distance can lead to a lack of inner peace and a feeling of emptiness.
- **Social Impact:** Missing prayer can weaken self-discipline and moral values. A society where many skip prayer may struggle with maintaining ethical and moral standards.

Hereafter Consequences:

- **Severe Punishment:** In the Hereafter, those who consistently neglect prayer may face harsh punishment. This warning serves as a reminder to maintain regular prayer to protect oneself from divine retribution. (Surah Al-Muddathir, 74:42-43)
- **Loss of Intercession:** Prayer is a means by which the Prophet (ﷺ) intercedes on behalf of believers. Neglecting prayer means you might miss out on this help on the Day of Judgment.
- **Dire Outcome:** Persistent neglect of prayer can lead to very serious consequences in the life after death. It is seen as a major failing that can overshadow even other good deeds. (Surah Al-Ma'un, 107:4-5)

Catching Up on Missed Prayers (Qada)

- **When to Make Up:** If you miss a prayer by accident (like falling asleep or forgetting), make it up as soon as you remember.
- **Hadith Guidance:** "Whoever forgets a prayer, let him pray it as soon as he remembers. There is no expiation other than this." (Bukhari, Muslim)
- **Conditions for Qada:**
 - Sincere repentance for missing the prayer
 - Resolve not to repeat the mistake
- **Note on Deliberate Neglect:** Skipping prayer on purpose is a serious sin. It requires both making up the missed prayer and true, heartfelt repentance.

Benefits of Establishing Salah

- **Forgiveness and Mercy:**
 - Prayer is a way to ask for forgiveness and receive Allah's mercy
 - "O you who have believed, seek help through patience and prayer. Indeed, Allah is with the patient." (Surah Al-Baqarah, 2:153)
- **Unity of the Ummah:**
 - Congregational prayers build strong community bonds
- **Divine Protection:**
 - Prayer acts as a shield, protecting one from evil and misdeeds

Prayer from a Modern Science Perspective

What Science Says:

- Prayer is similar to meditation and deep reflection.
- It benefits our body, mind, and emotions.

Key Points:

- **Mindfulness:** Helps you stay present and aware.
- **Stress Reduction:** Lowers stress and anxiety levels.
- **Improved Focus:** Boosts concentration and self-discipline.

Hereafter Benefits of Prayer

- **Path to Forgiveness:** Prayer Opens the door to Allah's mercy and cleanses the soul (Surah Hud, 11:114)
- **First Accountability:** On the Day of Judgment, prayer is the first act to be judged. (Hadith from Tirmidhi)
- **Reward in Paradise:** Praying regularly brings blessings and rewards in Paradise. (Surah Al-Mu'minun, 23:1-2)
- **Protection from Hellfire:** Prayer acts like a shield, protecting you from punishment. (Hadith from Muslim)
- **Elevated Status:** Regular prayer increases your rank and status in the sight of Allah.

Fasting as an Obligation

- **Key Points:**
- Fasting is required for every adult, sane, and capable Muslim.
- It is clearly mentioned in the Quran and Hadith.
- **Quran Verses:**
- “O you who have believed, fasting is prescribed for you...” (Surah Al-Baqarah 2:183)
- “The month of Ramadan [is that] in which was revealed the Qur'an...” (Surah Al-Baqarah 2:185)
- **Hadith Reminder:**
- The Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) said, “Islam is built upon five pillars...” (Bukhari)

Virtues of Fasting in Ramadan

- **Attaining Taqwa (Piety):** Fasting helps increase God-consciousness and self-restraint.
- **Immense Rewards:** Good deeds are multiplied, and fasting is specially rewarded by Allah.
- **Forgiveness of Sins:** Fasting with true faith leads to the forgiveness of past sins.
- **Entry into Paradise:** A special gate in Paradise (Ar-Rayyan) is for those who fast.
- **Spiritual Upliftment:** Ramadan, the month of the Quran, strengthens our bond with Allah’s word.

Importance of Fasting

- **Obedience to Allah:** Fasting shows our submission to Allah’s commands.
- **Detachment from Material Desires:** It helps control physical urges like eating, drinking, and marital relations during daylight.
- **Empathy for the Poor:** Experiencing hunger makes us more compassionate toward those in need.
- **Health Benefits:** Fasting cleanses the body, sharpens the mind, and improves overall health.
- **Communal Bonding:** Fasting brings Muslims together around the world in worship and unity.

Consequences of Neglecting Fasting

- **Spiritual and Moral Consequences:** Breaking or skipping a fast without a valid reason is a serious sin.
- **Quranic Warning:** Deliberate disobedience in fasting labels one among the sinners.
- **Hadith Warning:** The Prophet warned that those who break the fast may face severe consequences, symbolized by the image of “cheeks being torn.”
- **Worldly and Hereafter Losses:** Loss of Allah’s mercy, spiritual decline, and missing the gate of Ar-Rayyan in Paradise. Possible punishment in the grave and Hellfire.

Punishment for Intentionally Skipping or Breaking a Fast

- **According to the Quran:** Those who ignore Allah’s command may be held accountable on the Day of Judgment. Skipping the fast is seen as neglecting a vital duty.
- **According to the Hadith:** The Prophet (ﷺ) warned of severe consequences for breaking the fast. If a fast is deliberately broken (by eating, drinking, or marital relations), the person must:
 - Fast for two consecutive months (60 days), or
 - Feed 60 poor people (expiation).
- A missed fast also means losing the immense rewards promised by Allah.

Worldly Benefits of Fasting According to Modern Science

- **Metabolic Health:** Helps control blood sugar, reduces insulin resistance, and improves cholesterol levels.
- **Detoxification & Cell Repair:** The body cleans out toxins and repairs cells (process called autophagy).
- **Weight Loss:** Supports fat burning and helps reduce body fat.
- **Enhanced Brain Function:** Increases brain chemicals (like BDNF) that boost brain health and protect against diseases.
- **Reduced Inflammation:** Lowers inflammation, reducing the risk of many chronic illnesses.
- **Heart Health:** Helps lower blood pressure and improve overall cardiovascular health.
- **Mental Clarity & Emotional Balance:** The discipline of fasting can improve focus, mental clarity, and emotional stability.

4th Pillar Zakat (Obligatory Charity)

What is Zakat?

Zakat is a core duty in Islam and one of the five pillars. It is meant to purify wealth, help those in need, and balance society.

Translation of Verse 60 of Surah At-Tawbah “Zakat expenditures are only for the poor and the needy, and those employed to collect it, and for bringing hearts together [for Islam], and for freeing captives [slaves], and for those in debt, and for the cause of Allah, and for the [stranded] traveler—an obligation [imposed] by Allah. And Allah is Knowing and Wise.”(Surah At-Tawbah, 9:60)

This verse clearly explains the specific purposes for which Zakat should be spent.

Recipients of Zakat

1. **Who Can Receive Zakat? The Poor (Al-Fuqara):** Those who do not have enough money for basic needs.
2. **The Needy (Al-Masakin):** People who are slightly better off than the poor but still need help.
3. **Zakat Collectors (Al-'Amileen 'Alayha):** Individuals appointed to collect, manage, and distribute Zakat.
4. **Those Whose Hearts Need to be Reconciled (Mu'allafatul Quloob):** New converts or people who need support to strengthen their faith.
5. **For Freeing Captives (Fi Ar-Riqab):** Assisting slaves or prisoners to gain freedom.
6. **For Those in Debt (Al-Gharimeen):** Helping individuals burdened with debts incurred for lawful reasons.
7. **In the Cause of Allah (Fi Sabeelillah):** Supporting projects that serve Islam (e.g., building mosques, religious education).
8. **The Stranded Traveler (Ibn As-Sabeel):** Travelers who have run out of money and need help to return home.

Restrictions on Giving Zakat

Zakat Must Only Go to the Above Eight Groups:

It cannot be given to:

- Wealthy or self-sufficient individuals.
- Direct family members (parents, children, grandparents, etc.).
- One's own spouse.
- Any cause not mentioned in the eight categories.

Zakat is a sacred duty with clear guidelines that must be followed exactly as revealed by Allah.

Virtue & Importance of Paying Zakat

Why is Zakat Important? It is a pillar of Islam and an obligation for every eligible Muslim. Zakat purifies one's wealth and soul, removing greed and selfishness.

Virtues of Zakat:

Purification of Wealth and Soul:

- Helps cleanse our wealth and our hearts from materialism.
- Quran Reminder: "Take from their wealth a charity by which you purify them..." (Surah At-Tawbah, 9:103)

Increased Blessings and Sustenance:

- The act of giving brings barakah (divine blessings) to one's wealth.
- The Prophet (ﷺ) said, "Wealth is not diminished by giving in charity."

Compassion and Social Solidarity:

- Bridges the gap between rich and poor, encouraging unity.

Divine Reward & Key to Paradise:

- Zakat is seen as a sign of faith and a way to earn Allah's rewards.
- Hadith Example: "Charity extinguishes sins as water extinguishes fire." (Tirmidhi)

Importance of Zakat in Society

- **Economic Stability:** Redistributes wealth to reduce poverty and economic differences.
- **Obligation in Islam:** Just as important as prayer and fasting, fulfilling Zakat shows obedience to Allah.
- **Moral Responsibility:** Promotes empathy and care for the less fortunate.
- **Spiritual Development:** Helps remove the heart from excessive materialism and connects it to Allah.

Warnings and Consequences for Not Paying Zakat

- **Spiritual Warnings:** Neglecting Zakat is a serious sin that invites Allah's anger.
- **Quran Warning:** "And those who hoard gold and silver and spend it not in the way of Allah—give them tidings of a painful punishment." (Surah At-Tawbah, 9:34)
- **Hadith Warning:** The Prophet (ﷺ) warned that wealth not given in charity may bring severe punishment, symbolized by vivid imagery.
- **Worldly Consequences:** Loss of blessings and barakah in wealth. Increased social problems such as poverty, greed, and lack of unity. Possible divine punishments (e.g., drought, famine).
- **Hereafter Consequences:** Severe torment and regret on the Day of Judgment. Loss of Paradise and Allah's mercy. Rejection of the Prophet's negotiation.

As Muslims, fulfilling our Zakat obligation not only cleanses our wealth but also helps build a caring and just community, ultimately paving the way for eternal rewards in the Hereafter.

5th Pillar Hajj/Pilgrimage

Obligation of Hajj: Hajj is a required act of worship for every eligible Muslim at least once in their lifetime.

Hajj is one of the five pillars of Islam. It is a special journey to the holy city of Makkah. Hajj is an act of worship, submission, and unity for Muslims who are physically and financially able.

- **Quranic Evidence:** “And [due] to Allah from the people is a pilgrimage to the House—for whoever is able to find a way thereto...” (Surah Aal-e-Imran, 3:97)
- This verse reminds us that performing Hajj is a duty and neglecting it shows ungratefulness.
- **Hadith Evidence:** The Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) said, “Islam is built on five pillars... and performing Hajj to the House (Kaaba) for those who are able to do so.” (Bukhari, Muslim)
- He also urged, “Hasten to perform Hajj, for no one knows what will happen to him.” (Musnad Ahmad)

Benefits of Hajj

- **Forgiveness of Sins:** The Prophet (ﷺ) said, “Whoever performs Hajj and does not commit any obscenity or wrongdoing will come out as the day he or she was born—pure and free of sins.” (Bukhari, Muslim)
- **Massive Rewards:** A successful and accepted Hajj earns the reward of Paradise.
- **Unity and Brotherhood:** Hajj brings together Muslims from all over the world, showing equality and unity regardless of race or status.
- **Renewal of Faith:** The journey strengthens our connection with Allah and renews our spiritual energy.
- **Witnessing Sacred Rituals:** Pilgrims follow the footsteps of the Prophets, remembering the examples of Prophet Ibrahim (AS) and Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ).

Importance of Hajj

- **Test of Submission:** Hajj requires sacrifice, patience, and devotion, proving our willingness to obey Allah.
- **Connection with Holy History:** Pilgrims revisit sites linked to Prophet Ibrahim (AS) and his family, deepening their bond with Islamic heritage.
- **Fulfillment of a Pillar of Islam:** Not performing Hajj without a valid reason is seen as a lack in one’s faith.
- **Promotion of Taqwa (Piety):** The formal procedure(rituals) help teach humility, discipline, and a strong awareness of Allah in our hearts.

Warning & Consequences for Neglecting Hajj

- **Quranic Warning:** “And whoever disbelieves—then indeed, Allah is free from need of the worlds.” (Surah Aal- e-Imran, 3:97)
- Neglecting Hajj is a sign of ingratitude and rising against Allah.
- **Hadith Warning:** The Prophet (ﷺ) warned, “Whoever possesses provisions and a means of transportation to bring him to the House of Allah and yet does not perform Hajj...” (Tirmidhi, Ahmad)
- **Worldly Harm:**
 - Spiritual Decline:** Missing Hajj weakens faith and reduces blessings (barakah) in life.
 - Social Disconnection:** Hajj builds community bonds.
- **Harm in the Hereafter:**
 - Accountability:** Those who ignore Hajj will be questioned by Allah on the Day of Judgment.
 - Loss of Forgiveness:** They miss the chance to have their sins wiped away and lose the reward of Paradise.

Rituals of Hajj (Manasik-e-Hajj)

Hajj has specific rituals performed in a fixed order. There are seven main rituals, each with a special meaning and purpose.

Ritual 1 – Ihram (State of Purity)

Definition: Entering a holy state of purity before starting Hajj.

How to Prepare: Men wear two unstitched white cloths. Women dress modestly, following Islamic guidelines.

Recitation: Pilgrims recite the Talbiyah:

“Labbayka Allahumma Labbayk. Labbayka la sharika laka labbayk. Inna al-hamda wa an- ni'mata laka wal-mulk. La sharika lak.”

(Meaning: “Here I am, O Allah, here I am. You have no partner. Here I am. Verily, all praise, blessings, and sovereignty belong to You.”)

Ritual 2 – Tawaf (Circumambulation of the Kaaba)

Definition: Walking around the Kaaba seven times in a counterclockwise direction.

Importance: Symbolizes the central role of the Kaaba and unity with Allah.

How to Perform: Start at the Black Stone (Hajr Aswad) and complete seven circuits while praying and supplicating.

Ritual 3 – Sa'i (Walking Between Safa and Marwah)

Definition: Walking back and forth between the hills of Safa and Marwah seven times.

Importance: Remembers Hagar's search for water for her son, Ismail (AS) and Allah's miracle of providing Zamzam water.

How to Perform: Begin at Safa, move to Marwah, and repeat, reciting prayers and supplications.

Ritual 4 – Wuquf at Arafat (Standing at Arafat)

Definition: Walking around the Kaaba seven times in a counterclockwise direction.

Importance: Symbolizes the central role of the Kaaba and unity with Allah.

How to Perform: Start at the Black Stone (Hajr Aswad) and complete seven circuits while praying and supplicating.

Ritual 5 – Muzdalifah (Collecting Pebbles)

Definition: After sunset on the Day of Arafat, pilgrims travel to Muzdalifah.

Actions: Pray Maghrib and Isha together. Collect 49 or 70 pebbles for use in the next ritual.

Ritual 6 – Rami al-Jamarat (Stoning the Pillars)

Definition: Throwing pebbles at three pillars in Mina that represent Satan's temptations.

How to Perform: Begin on the 10th of Dhul-Hijjah by throwing seven pebbles at the largest pillar (Jamarat al-Aqaba), then continue for the other pillars.

Importance: This act symbolizes the rejection of evil and the commitment to follow Allah's guidance..

Ritual 7 – Qurbani (Animal Sacrifice)

Definition: Sacrificing an animal (such as a sheep, goat, cow, or camel) to remember Prophet Ibrahim's (AS) willingness to sacrifice his son, Ismail (AS).

Importance: Shows obedience to Allah and provides meat for the poor.

Additional Rituals of Hajj

Tawaf al-Ifadah: Another circumambulation of the Kaaba performed after the main rituals, symbolizing spiritual cleansing.

Halq or Taqsir (Shaving or Trimming Hair): Men shave or trim their hair; women cut a small portion. This act represents humility and renewal.

Tawaf al-Wada (Farewell Tawaf): The final circumambulation before leaving Makkah, marking the conclusion of Hajj.

Chap 3 The Noble Quran (Revelation/Miracles/Compilation)

Introduction

- **Definition of Revelation (Wahi):** In Islam, revelation is the way Allah communicates His guidance and messages to humanity. This communication is given to His chosen prophets through different forms so that people may understand and follow His commands.
- **Purpose:** The varied forms of revelation were meant to suit different situations, contexts, and the nature of the messages being delivered.

Forms and Types of Revelation

A. Direct Speech (Without an Intermediary)

What It Is: In this rare form, Allah speaks directly to a prophet without any intermediary such as an angel.

Examples: Prophet Musa (Moses): Allah spoke directly to Musa at Mount Sinai.

The Quran mentions:

"And Allah spoke to Musa directly." (Surah An-Nisa, 4:164) Prophet Muhammad (Mi'raj):

During the Night of Ascension (Mi'raj), Allah directly communicated with Muhammad (peace be upon him), including the ordainment of the five daily prayers.

B. Revelation Through an Angel (Most Commonly via Jibreel)

What It Is: The most common way prophets received revelation was through an angel, usually Angel Jibreel (Gabriel). He is known as the "messenger to the messengers."

Example: The entire Quran was revealed to Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) through Jibreel, as indicated in the verse:

"Say, [O Muhammad], 'Whoever is an enemy to Gabriel...' (Surah Al-Baqarah, 2:97)

Forms of Angelic Revelation:

- **As a Human:** Sometimes, Jibreel appeared in the form of a man. An example of this is seen in the well-known Hadith where he questioned Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) about Islam, Iman (faith), and Ihsan (excellence).
- **Unseen but Audible:** There were times when the Prophet only heard Jibreel's voice, without seeing him, receiving the message as a sound or resonance.
- **True Angelic Form:** On a couple of occasions, Jibreel appeared in his true form, displaying such a majestic presence that he filled the entire horizon.

C. Direct Speech (Without an Intermediary)

What It Is: Sometimes, Allah directly fills the heart of a prophet with divine guidance or knowledge. This inner inspiration, known as Ilham, does not involve any physical or audible form.

Examples: The mother of Prophet Musa received divine guidance instructing her to place her baby in a basket in the river for his protection.

""And We inspired to the mother of Moses, 'Suckle him; but when you fear for him, cast him into the river...'"(Surah Al-Qasas, 28:7)

D. True Dreams (Ru'ya al-Sadiqa)

What It Is: True dreams are a special form of revelation, different from regular dreams. They serve as a way for prophets to receive important messages.

Examples 1: Prophet Ibrahim (Abraham): He saw in a dream that he must sacrifice his son, Ismail, as a command from Allah.

""And when he reached with him [the age of] exertion, he said, 'O my son, indeed I have seen in a dream...'"(Surah As-Saffat, 37:102)

Examples 2: Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him): Early in his prophethood, the Prophet began receiving true dreams which were later followed by the angelic revelation of the Quran.

E. Veiled Communication (Behind a Veil)

What It Is: In this form, Allah's communication is delivered in a way that His presence is not directly seen, maintaining a respectful distance.

Examples: When Prophet Musa encountered the burning bush, Allah spoke from behind it.

"And when he came to it, he was called, 'O Moses, indeed I am your Lord, so remove your sandals...'"(Surah Ta-Ha, 20:11-12)

F. Revelation Filling the Prophet's Heart (Wahy al-Qalb)

What It Is: This type of revelation occurs when the prophet's heart is filled with divine knowledge and guidance. It is an internal experience, not necessarily linked to a spoken word or vision.

Examples: This form is linked to the comprehensive guidance that filled Prophet Muhammad's (peace be upon him) heart. Even in times when specific verses were not being revealed, his heart was full of divine insight that enabled him to lead and provide guidance.

Excellence and Importance of the Quran

Why the Quran is Special: The Quran is regarded as the final revelation from Allah, offering clear evidence of His mercy, wisdom, and guidance. It shapes our morals, spirituality, and our relationship with Allah.

Quranic Verses on the Importance of the Quran

A. Guidance and Light for Humanity

Quran Verse: **"This is the Book about which there is no doubt, a guidance for those conscious of Allah."** (Surah Al-Baqarah, 2:2)

This verse reminds us that the Quran is a clear source of guidance for all believers, leading us to a path of righteousness.

B. Clear Evidence

Quran Verse: **"O mankind, there has come to you a conclusive proof from your Lord, and we have sent down to you a clear light."** (Surah An-Nisa, 4:174)

The Quran acts as undeniable evidence from Allah, illuminating the truth for everyone.

C. Healing and Mercy

Quran Verse: **""And we send down from the Quran that which is healing and mercy for the believers..."** (Surah Al-Isra, 17:82)

D. Reminder for Mankind

Quran Verse: **"Indeed, we have sent down to you a Book in which is your mention. Then will you not reason?"** (Surah Al-Anbiya, 21:10)

The Quran is a reminder of our existence, our duties, and our purpose in life, prompting us to think and reflect.

E. Protection and Preservation by Allah

Quran Verse: "Indeed, it is we who sent down the Quran, and indeed, We will be its guardian." (Surah Al-Hijr, 15:9)

This verse assures us that Allah protects the Quran from any alteration, preserving its original message for all time.

Hadiths on the Importance of the Quran

A. Superiority of the Quran

Hadith: The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

"The best of you are those who learn the Quran and teach it." (Sahih al-Bukhari)

This expresses that those who study and share the Quran are held in high honor

B. Intercession on the Day of Judgment

Hadith: The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said: **"Recite the Quran, for it will come as an intercessor for its reciters on the Day of Resurrection." (Sahih Muslim)**

The Quran will advocate for its readers on the Day of Judgment, highlighting its role as a protector and helper.

C. Elevating Status in Paradise

Hadith: The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said: **"It will be said to the companion of the Quran (one who memorizes or frequently recites the Quran), 'Recite and ascend (in ranks), as you used to recite when you were in the world. Your rank will be at the last verse you recite.'" (Sunan Abu Dawood)**

This hadith shows that the more one engages with the Quran, the higher their status in Paradise.

D. Reward for Reciting

Hadith: The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said: **"Whoever recites a letter from the Book of Allah will receive a good deed as ten times its like. I do not say that Alif-Laam-Meem is a letter, but Alif is a letter, Laam is a letter, and Meem is a letter." (Sunan At-Tirmidhi)**

This encourages us to recite the Quran, as every letter brings immense rewards.

E. Heart's Illumination

Hadith: The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said: **"Indeed, the one who does not have anything of the Quran in his heart is like a ruined house." (Sunan At-Tirmidhi)**

This emphasizes that a heart filled with the Quran is like a well-maintained home, full of light and life.

F. Guidance and Relief from Darkness

Hadith: The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said: **"I leave behind me two things: the Quran and my Sunnah, and if you follow these, you will never go astray." (Muwatta Malik)**

Following the Quran and the Prophet's Sunnah ensures that we are guided correctly and protected from the errors of life.

The Quran and Hadith highlight the Quran's unmatched excellence. It is a guide, a source of light, healing, and protection, and it carries immense rewards for those who read, memorize, and teach it. The Quran not only directs us in our daily lives but also offers spiritual intercession and elevates our status in the hereafter.

Embracing the teachings of the Quran brings us closer to Allah, fills our hearts with wisdom, and prepares us for the eternal life in Paradise. Let us strive to learn, reflect upon, and share the divine message contained in the Holy Quran.

Miracle of the Qur'an

Introduction and Importance and Usefulness of the Miracle of the Qur'an

In this topic, we will discuss the miracle of the Qur'an (I'jaz al-Qur'an). This concept highlights the Qur'an's divine origin and its unique qualities that no human can replicate. It serves as strong evidence of Allah's revelation to Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) and strengthens the faith of believers.

A. Proof of Divine Origin

The miracle of the Qur'an shows that it is a divine revelation from Allah. Its language, wisdom, and structure are unmatched.

Qur'anic Challenge:

Allah challenges doubters by saying: "And if you are in doubt about what We have sent down upon Our Servant, then produce a surah the like thereof and call upon your witnesses other than Allah, if you should be truthful." (Surah Al-Baqarah, 2:23)

Explanation: This challenge, which remains unmet for over 1400 years, confirms that the Qur'an is beyond human ability and is truly from Allah.

B. Source of Guidance and Conviction

The miraculous nature of the Qur'an reinforces the belief and conviction of Muslims.

Explanation: Knowing that the Qur'an is a divine miracle helps believers appreciate its guidance and encourages them to follow its teachings sincerely, knowing that its wisdom comes directly from Allah.

C. Inspiration for Reflection and Study

The miracle of the Qur'an inspires both scholars and ordinary people to study and reflect upon its verses.

Explanation:

Its unique language and deep meanings have given rise to fields like tafsir (interpretation) and balagha (eloquence). This constant study not only enriches our understanding but also promotes lifelong learning and intellectual growth.

D. Preservation of the Arabic Language and Culture

The Qur'an's linguistic excellence has played a major role in preserving the Arabic language.

Explanation:

Its smoothness, structure, and poetic style set high standards in Arabic literature. As a result, the classical Arabic language remains preserved and continues to be a vital part of Arabic culture and heritage.

E. Moral and Spiritual Motivation

Understanding the Qur'an as a divine miracle motivates Muslims to adhere to its guidance.

Explanation:

Knowing that the message is miraculous and divinely prescribed encourages believers to follow its moral teachings with dedication, leading to a fulfilling and righteous life.

F. Evidence for Prophethood

The miracle of the Qur'an serves as a strong argument for the prophethood of Muhammad (peace be upon him).

Explanation:

Although Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) was "unlettered" (ummi) and did not know how to read or write, the Qur'an's unmatched beauty and depth clearly indicate that it must have come from Allah, thus confirming his prophethood.

G. Scientific I'jaz and the Encouragement of Knowledge

Some aspects of the Qur'an include knowledge about the natural world and cosmic phenomena that were unknown at the time.

Qur'anic Reference:

"We will show them Our signs in the horizons and within themselves until it becomes clear to them that it is the truth..."
(Surah Fussilat, 41:53)

Explanation:

These references encourage Muslims to pursue scientific research and knowledge. They show that faith and science can go hand in hand, inspiring discovery and understanding of the world.

The miracle of the Qur'an is a powerful reminder of its divine origin and its supreme excellence. It provides clear evidence of Allah's revelation, strengthens the faith of believers, inspires continuous study and reflection, preserves the Arabic language, motivates moral and spiritual behavior, and even supports the scientific quest for knowledge.

The Qur'an is not only a book of guidance but also a timeless miracle that continues to enrich the lives of Muslims around the world, bridging the gap between the divine and human understanding.

Efforts in Compilation of the Holy Quran

Introduction Compilation During the Lifetime of Prophet Muhammad

The Holy Quran was revealed gradually over 23 years. From the beginning, special care was taken to keep its words safe and unchanged. In this lesson, we will learn about the three main stages in the compilation process.

Compilation During the Lifetime of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him)

How It Was Preserved During the Prophet's Time:

The Quran was not written as one complete book during the Prophet's lifetime.

It was recorded in many different ways, including being memorized by his companions and written down on various materials.

A. Oral Memorization: Many companions of the Prophet memorized the Quran exactly as it was revealed. This tradition, called hifz (memorization), was very important because the Arabs had a strong oral tradition.

- B. **Written Recordings** The Prophet asked his scribes to write down the verses on different materials such as parchment, leather, stones, and bones. These writings were carefully arranged as the verses were revealed.
- C. **Verification by the Prophet** The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) would often review the verses with Angel Jibreel (Gabriel). In his final year, he conducted a final review called “Al- Ardah al-Akhirah” to confirm the order and correctness of the verses.

Compilation During the Caliphate of Abu Bakr (may Allah be pleased with him)

Need for a Single Book: After the Prophet passed away, many of those who memorized the Quran (huffaz) were martyred in the Battle of Yamama. This made it urgent to collect the verses into one written manuscript.

- A. **Leadership by Zaid ibn Thabit:** Caliph Abu Bakr appointed Zaid ibn Thabit, a trusted scribe, to collect the verses because of his deep knowledge of the Quran.
- B. **Stringent Collection Process:** Zaid gathered all the written pieces from various sources. He then checked every verse with several witnesses who had memorized the Quran to make sure everything was correct.
- C. **Completion of the Mus’haf:** After careful verification, all the verses were organized into one complete book, known as the Mus’haf. This Mus’haf was first kept by Caliph Abu Bakr, then passed on to Caliph Umar, and later to Hafsa bint-e-Umar, one of the Prophet’s widows.

Compilation During the Caliphate of Uthman(may Allah be pleased with him)

Need for Standardization: As Islam spread to many regions, differences in dialects started to appear in the recitation of the Quran. To avoid confusion, Caliph Uthman decided to create a standard copy.

- A. **Formation of a Committee:** Caliph Uthman formed a committee led by Zaid ibn Thabit along with other knowledgeable companions. Their task was to use the Mus’haf from Abu Bakr as the base.
- B. **Standardization and Distribution:** The committee produced several identical copies of the Quran, known as Uthmanic codices. These copies were sent to major Islamic centers like Makkah, Kufa, Basra, and Damascus.
- C. **Preservation of Dialects:** The standardized text was based on the Quraish dialect—the same dialect spoken by the Prophet. This helped in keeping the recitation uniform for all Muslims.
- D. **Importance of the Compilation Efforts:** These careful efforts ensured that the Quran has been preserved in its original, unaltered form. Today, Muslims around the world read and memorize the same text, just as it was compiled and verified in the early days of Islam.

The preservation and compilation of the Quran occurred in three clear stages:

During the Prophet’s Lifetime: Through memorization, writing, and regular verification.

During Caliph Abu Bakr’s Time: With the urgent collection led by Zaid ibn Thabit after many huffaz were lost.

During Caliph Uthman’s Time: By standardizing and distributing the text across the Muslim world.

These efforts show the great care and dedication early Muslims had in keeping the words of Allah safe. The result is the Quran we have today—a timeless and accurate guide for all generations.

Notes on Chapter 4: Islam and Modern Science

1. Quran and Modern Science

- The Quran contains descriptions of natural phenomena that align with modern scientific discoveries, despite being revealed over 1,400 years ago.
- These alignments are seen as evidence of the Quran’s divine origin.

Key Topics:

- **Human Embryo Development** (Quranic stages match modern embryology).
- **Expanding Universe** (Quran mentions expansion; Hubble confirmed it).
- **Big Bang Theory** (Quran describes heavens and earth as once joined).
- **Role of Water in Life** (Quran states all life originates from water).
- **Protective Atmosphere** (Quran describes the sky as a protective shield).
- **Mountains as Pegs** (Quran compares mountains to stabilizers; geology confirms deep roots).
- **Barrier Between Salt and Fresh Water** (Quran mentions a barrier; oceanography identifies haloclines).

- **Cloud and Rain Formation** (Quran describes the process accurately).

2. Contributions of Muslim Scientists

- **Islamic Golden Age (8th–14th century)**: Muslim scientists made groundbreaking advancements by blending Quranic teachings with empirical research.

Key Fields and Scholars:

- **Astronomy:**

Al-Battani: Measured the solar year accurately.

Al-Zarqali: Designed advanced astrolabes.

- **Medicine:**

Al-Razi (Rhazes): Differentiated smallpox and measles; wrote *Kitab al-Hawi*.

Ibn Sina (Avicenna): Wrote *The Canon of Medicine*; introduced quarantine.

Al-Zahrawi (Albucasis): Pioneered surgical tools and techniques.

- **Mathematics:**

Al-Khwarizmi: "Father of algebra"; introduced algorithms.

Omar Khayyam: Solved cubic equations; improved calendars.

- **Physics & Engineering:**

Ibn al-Haytham (Alhazen): Pioneered optics and scientific method.

- **Chemistry:**

Jabir ibn Hayyan (Geber): "Father of chemistry"; invented distillation.

- **Geography:**

Al-Idrisi: Created detailed world maps.

Ibn Battuta: Documented travels across 75,000 miles.

3. Integration of Quranic Teachings with Science

- **Observation & Reflection**: Quran encourages studying nature (e.g., "*Do they not look into the realm of the heavens...?*" – Surah Al-A'raf 7:185).
- **Unity of Knowledge**: Faith and science are complementary; understanding nature deepens belief.
- **Practical Applications**: Muslim scientists improved medicine, engineering, and daily life, aligning with Quranic ethics of serving humanity.

Impact on the World:

- Preserved and expanded Greek/Roman knowledge during Europe's Dark Ages.
- Influenced the European Renaissance (e.g., translations of Muslim works into Latin).
- Demonstrated harmony between faith and reason, inspiring modern ethical science.

Key Quranic Verses on Knowledge:

- "*Read in the name of your Lord who created...*" (Surah Al-Alaq 96:1).
- "*Seeking knowledge is an obligation upon every Muslim.*" (Hadith, Ibn Majah).

Conclusion

- The Quran's scientific accuracy and Muslim scholars' contributions highlight Islam's encouragement of knowledge.
- Their legacy bridges faith and science, proving that ethical inquiry and discovery are integral to Islamic tradition.
- Modern science continues to validate Quranic insights, reinforcing the belief in its divine origin.

Key Takeaway: Islam promotes a holistic approach to learning, where scientific exploration is both an intellectual and spiritual pursuit.